

purchasing habits. These questions come from our TV audience.

CUSTOM-MADE, OR OFF THE RACK?

First, Johnny, Mr. J. G. from our audience wants to know: “What’s the most you ever spent for a suit of clothing?”

Johnny closes his eyes for a moment. Obviously, he is deep in thought. The audience is silent. It is expecting him to say, “Somewhere between \$1,000 and \$6,000.” But our research indicates that the audience’s expectations are wrong. We predict that our prototypical millionaire would say:

The most I ever spent... the most I ever spent... including the suits I bought for myself and for my wife, June, and my sons, Buddy and Darryl, and my girls, Wyleen and Ginger ... the most I ever spent was \$399. Boy, I remember that it’s the most I ever spent. It was for a very special occasion—our twenty-fifth wedding anniversary party.

How will the audience respond to Johnny’s statement? Probably with shock and disbelief. The audience’s expectations are not congruent with the reality of most American millionaires.

According to our most recent survey, the typical American millionaire reported that he (she) never spent more than \$399 for a suit of clothing for himself or for anyone else. Note the figures given in [Table 2-1](#). Fifty percent or more of the millionaires surveyed paid \$399 or less for the most expensive suit they ever purchased. Only about one in ten paid \$1,000 or more; only about one in one hundred paid \$2,800 or more. Conversely, about one in four millionaires paid \$285 or less, and one in ten paid \$195 or less for his (her) most expensive suit.